Jay Shepard – 'Moon Glow'

Jay Shepard talks about how he harnesses light in this turned artwork

'Moon Glow': wood, acrylic paint, water-based lacquer, selenite 90 x 195 x 195mm

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Jay Shepard holds a Bachelor of Arts degree and a Master of Fine Arts degree. His Masters degree emphasized painting and drawing. Over time he moved into woodworking, initially focusing on creating wood furniture. That has evolved into creating art pieces from wood and he now concentrates almost exclusively on woodturning.

Jay tells us about his piece: "Light. Light is unseen. We occasionally see its source. We observe light when it is reflected off things. When the moon rises, for example, we see the moon glow, which is light from the sun reflecting off the moon's surface.

"Constructed of wood, acrylic paint, lacquer and selenite mineral, 'Moon Glow' is a collaboration of disparate materials with like character that take advantage of the behavior of light. Together, with light, they create an overall effect of glow. Light, while not a material *per se*, is very much an integral part of this piece and is as important to the overall nature of the piece as all the rest of the materials used.

"'Moon Glow' is a box made of maple with a polychrome finish. Selenite mineral is inlayed in the outer rim. Selenite is a mineral crystal that refracts light, contributing to the overall feel and sensation of the piece. The chatoyance in the wood of the lid helps emphasize and represent the moon. The paint uses a mica-based pigment and has a reflecting character. The paint is applied layer upon layer building the surface to create an illusion of depth and shimmering colours. Inside the vessel and lid the viewer is given an additional surprise with images of a nebula or deep space. Airbrush and paint brush were used to build the surfaces.

"Much of the work I do is inspired by images of deep space and most recently the pictures sent back to us by the Hubble Space Telescope. These images combined with the thought of what could be out there, I am only limited by my imagination and the ability of my hands to create."

Jay concludes with an inspiring quote from Shakespeare's Hamlet: "There are more things in heaven and earth, Horatio, than are dreamt of in your philosophy."

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